IT Helpdesk Standard Operating Procedures Manual

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1. Purpose

This manual defines the standard procedures followed by the IT Service Desk in logging, prioritising, and resolving employee IT support requests.

2. Ticket Logging

2.1 All support requests must be logged as a ticket in the IT Service Management (ITSM) system, whether received by phone, email, or the self-service portal, including a description of the issue and the affected system.

2.2 Tickets must be categorised at logging using the standard taxonomy: Hardware, Software, Network, Account Access, or Security.

3. Priority Classification

3.1 Tickets are classified into four priority levels: Critical (complete service outage affecting multiple users), High (significant impact on a single user's ability to work), Medium (inconvenience with a workaround available), and Low (minor issue or general request).

3.2 Target response times are: Critical — 15 minutes; High — 1 hour; Medium — 4 hours; Low — 1 working day. Target resolution times are set out in Appendix A.

4. Escalation

4.1 Tickets not resolved within the target resolution time must be escalated automatically by the ITSM system to the Level 2 support team, with the original analyst remaining the point of contact for the requester.

4.2 Critical tickets affecting more than ten users must be escalated immediately to the IT Manager and logged as a Major Incident under the Major Incident Management Procedure.

5. Password Resets and Account Access

5.1 Password reset requests require identity verification through the employee's registered mobile number or in-person verification with photo ID before the reset is processed.

5.2 Requests for elevated system access (e.g. administrator rights) require written approval from the requester's line manager before being actioned.

6. Remote Support

6.1 Analysts may request remote access to an employee's device to diagnose and resolve issues, but must obtain the employee's verbal consent before initiating a remote session, in accordance with the IT Acceptable Use Policy (EN-POL-01).

7. Ticket Closure

7.1 Tickets may only be closed once the requester has confirmed the issue is resolved, or after three unsuccessful attempts to contact the requester over a five working day period, whichever comes first.

8. Related Documents

- IT Acceptable Use Policy (EN-POL-01)
- Major Incident Management Procedure (IT-PROC-02)

9. Approval

Approved by the IT Service Delivery Manager on 20 May 2026.